



PROGRESS REPORT

South Sudan: progress report, September 2025 – September 2026

Edition of 2026-09-05 · 81 systems and instruments tracked

GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS · WHERE THE RECORD IS THIN

This report asks the same set of questions of every country. The rows below are a fixed frame of indicators, one row each, chosen in advance and covering all thirty-eight subjects the base tracks — so what appears here is decided by the frame and not by whichever records happened to accumulate. Each row says what happened on that indicator during the period, with every claim linked to the source it rests on.

Where a row reads *No evidence*, the base holds nothing on that indicator. **That is a statement about this base, not about the country** — it does not mean nothing exists, only that nothing has been collected here yet. The rows that carry evidence say what it is; the rows that do not are left to speak for themselves.

The period is 2025-09-01 to 2026-09-05.

Progress values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a reported position worsened. *Mixed* — the indicator's instruments moved in different directions in the period; the clause after the comma names which moved which way. *No change* — the base holds a standing position and nothing in the period touched it. *No evidence* — the base holds nothing on this indicator at all. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, regulations still pending*.

Governance

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	Digital transformation strategy	A presidential decree ordering full digitisation set a January 2026 adoption deadline, and the deadline passed without a compliance report. The decree granted an electronic services council full authority over the digitisation of public institutions (decree). The deadline passed and nothing on file records compliance, an extension or a report against it. The country is placed 192nd of 193 on the international electronic government index for 2024. A decree with a deadline and no compliance mechanism is the shape of much of this ledger, and the reason is recorded separately: there is no operating gazette in which an instrument can be published or checked.	STALLED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	ICT strategy		NO EVIDENCE
Strategies, plans and policies	Broadband strategy	A National Spectrum Management and 5G Strategy closed its inception workshop with methodology, work plan and governance structures agreed. The strategy is donor-financed through the regional digital integration project and consultant-led (strategy). No draft, spectrum award or timetable follows it. It is the only forward-looking connectivity instrument in this unit that is not a fibre route, and it is being written by external consultants inside a project the same lender finances.	ADVANCED
Strategies, plans and policies	Data storage / cloud strategy	Government data-hosting and cloud guidelines are recorded as unpublished, unchanged from a 2022 baseline against a 2028 target. They are a results indicator of the regional digital integration project and the lender records them as unpublished (guidelines). That absence bears directly on the national data centre and the international gateway, both operated by the same private company, and on the question of where government data currently sits – which nothing published answers.	NO CHANGE
Strategies, plans and policies	Data interoperability framework / roadmap		NO EVIDENCE
Strategies, plans and policies	AI strategy	No national artificial-intelligence strategy, policy or programme is held, and the ministry named infrastructure, a data centre and skills as prerequisites in April 2025. The undersecretary's statement of prerequisites is the whole of the record (prerequisites). Naming a data centre as a prerequisite is consistent with the rest of this ledger, where the national facility's own construction status is contested between two ministerial accounts and no procurement record exists.	NO CHANGE
Strategies, plans and policies	Data localisation policies		NO EVIDENCE
Strategies, plans and policies	Data governance policy		NO EVIDENCE
Strategies, plans and policies	Open data policy		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Legislation and regulation	Data protection legislation	No data-protection statute or commission exists, only a constitutional privacy right, and the minister states a bill will come after a policy bill drafted in October 2025. What stands is the Transitional Constitution's privacy article and nothing else: no statute and no commission as at August 2026 (absence). The minister stated in December 2025 that a bill will come in 2026, and a policy bill was drafted in October 2025 by a civil-society partnership (statement , feature , drafting). Meanwhile a biometric payroll register, a humanitarian biometric registration and a planned universal digital identity are all being built with no statute governing any of them.	ADVANCED
Legislation and regulation	Cybersecurity legislation	A Cyber Crimes and Computer Abuse Act was signed in February 2026, criminalising false information, online impersonation and hate speech alongside hacking, and the text is withheld. The bill passed in November 2025 and was signed on 18 February 2026, with the ministry setting out its operation the following day (signature , passage , operation , effect). The speech offences and the withheld text are the objections on record. The country has no data-protection statute, no privacy commission and no incident response team, so the first computer-crime statute is also the first digital statute of any kind. Its text cannot be read because there is no operating gazette, which is recorded separately.	ADVANCED
Legislation and regulation	Legislation covering digital id		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Legislation and regulation	Digital payments legislation	A National Payment System Bill went to a five-day validation workshop in August 2026, with no text, introduction date or parliamentary timetable held. The workshop opened on 10 August 2026 (workshop , transition , bill). The separately recorded national instant payment system has been planned since early 2025 and has not moved, so the statute and the rail are both at the stage of intention.	ADVANCED
Legislation and regulation	Legislation enabling data interoperability	An ICT Authority is being established while awaiting legislation, and a May 2026 account states the President already signed its legal framework; the two are unreconciled. Both accounts trace to one speaker. In May 2026 the minister said the law is out already and signed by the President; in August 2026 he was reported standing the body up while parliamentary legislation is awaited (establishment , framework). No bill, act, presidential order or gazette entry can be found. The justice ministry's law collection stops at 2017 and omits the cybercrime Act too, the Office of the President publishes no decrees, and the Assembly's bills register stops in 2023 — so the registers are not current enough for their silence to settle anything. The division of competence with the existing communications regulator is unstated. The qualified status is the resting state.	MIXED an ICT Authority reported both as legally established and as awaiting legislation, from the same speaker
Legislation and regulation	AI legislation / regulations		NO EVIDENCE
Legislation and regulation	E-commerce legislation	A national e-commerce strategy is recorded as non-existent in the regional project's seventh implementation report. The lender records it as non-existent (strategy). The same report records the same absence for two other parties to the project, so three parties have none between them.	NO CHANGE
Legislation and regulation	Statistics legislation		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Legislation and regulation	Access to information legislation	A technical committee was given fourteen days in January 2026 to launch an Official Gazette and clear a publication backlog of every law since 2011, and no edition is on file. The committee was formed by the President on 12 January 2026 (committee). A protocol issued the week before classifies all documents bearing the President's signature as privileged executive communication that cannot be photographed, scanned or shared online. Those two facts together are the single most consequential entry in this ledger. A country with no operating gazette and a rule against reproducing signed instruments cannot have its laws read, which is why the ICT Authority's status is unresolvable and why the cybercrime Act's text is withheld.	STALLED
Data protection	Data protection authority		NO EVIDENCE
Data protection	National data protection readiness		NO EVIDENCE
Regional collaboration	Regional policy collaboration	A ministerial visit to a continental telecommunications union produced a pledge of collaboration rather than an instrument. The visit was made to the union's regional headquarters in August 2026, and no workplan, contribution or membership status is stated (visit). It is recorded as a pledge rather than an instrument. Against a country whose fibre backbone is untendered, whose spectrum strategy is consultant-led and whose gateway is privately operated, a ministerial visit is the whole of the regional engagement the base can date.	ADVANCED
Regional collaboration	Regional legal harmonisation		NO EVIDENCE
Regional collaboration	Shared regional infrastructure	A cross-border digital connectivity memorandum with a neighbour is recorded as delivered, and a regional satellite feasibility study opened a joint funding account. The memorandum is recorded as delivered in the regional project's implementation report, and the signing date is not stated in it (memorandum). Partner states opened a joint funding account for a communications satellite feasibility study with deposits due 30 September 2026; neither the study's cost nor each state's share was disclosed (study). The country's fibre backbone runs through the same neighbour, so the memorandum is the legal frame under which its international capacity will arrive.	ADVANCED
Regional collaboration	Cross-border data transfers		NO EVIDENCE
Standards	National interoperability standards		NO EVIDENCE
Standards	National quality standards		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Standards	Adoption of international standards		NO EVIDENCE
Public debate and participation in policymaking	Non-governmental contribution to national policy		NO EVIDENCE
Public debate and participation in policymaking	Open discussion of government policy	The regulator ordered internet service providers to block social media for 30 to 90 days, a power exercised without a published legal basis. The information technology minister denied two documents alleging a US\$15m influence-buying transfer by the firms contracted for the e-government programme (report). The documents' authenticity is contested and the base holds no independent verification. The order was issued in January 2025 (order). No statutory basis, appeal route or duration determination is published for it. The cybercrime Act signed a year later criminalises false information, online impersonation and hate speech, so the same period saw both an administrative blocking power exercised and speech offences enacted, neither with a readable instrument behind it.	REGRESSED

Finance

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure	Sustainable domestic financing of digital transformation		NO EVIDENCE
MoUs and other agreements	Strategic relationships	An air traffic management system loan of US\$271,154,617 is the largest single tracked commitment on this ledger, at year precision. The commitment is dated to the year only (loan). It dwarfs every digital instrument recorded here, and nothing on file records disbursement, delivery or an operating system against it.	NO CHANGE
New investments	Mobilisation of non-state finance		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
New investments	Development-partner project financing	A regional digital integration project issued its seventh implementation report after a mid-term review, and private-sector investment mobilised under it has not moved. The project was approved in May 2023 and finances the spectrum and 5G strategy work as well as the fibre programme; its report is also the source for four separate absences recorded in this unit – cloud guidelines, an e-commerce strategy, an incident response team, and a cross-border memorandum (project). Private-sector investment mobilised under it has not moved (investment). One lender's implementation report is doing most of the work of a national statistical record here, which is a limit on this reading as much as a finding about the country.	MIXED a regional project financing the backbone, the spectrum strategy and the payroll register while private investment mobilised has not moved

ICT Infrastructure

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	Mobile penetration	A fifteen-year operator licence was awarded in April 2025, while a coverage extension expected from February 2026 has not been delivered. The licence was awarded in April 2025 (licence), and an operator launched embedded subscriber identity service in January 2025 (service). The coverage extension to one administrative area was expected from February 2026 and has not arrived. Operators are reported as citing doubts about revenue from the area, and no operator statement is held (coverage). That is the market answer to a low-income rural area with no universal service instrument to override it, and this base holds no such fund for the country.	ADVANCED
Connectivity	Internet usage	Internet users and penetration were reported by the regulator in July 2025, and no later national measurement is held. The figures are the regulator's own (figures). Thirteen months without a further measurement, in a period covering two tariff adjustments and a licence award, means the direction of use since then is unknown.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	Mobile affordability	Three tariff adjustments on exchange-rate grounds brought Parliament to summon the information minister, after an operator cut tariffs 25 per cent in December 2025. The adjustments ran through 2026 in three phases and no regulator determination, tariff schedule or operator justification is published; Parliament moved to summon the minister on 21 August 2026 (summons , phase three , phase two , second , operator , first). An operator cut tariffs by 25 per cent in December 2025 with the ministry pressing for more (cut), and the revised rates after the adjustments are unpublished (price , editorial). So the direction is a cut followed by three rises, none of which can be quantified from anything published.	REGRESSED
Connectivity	National fibre backbone	A commercial fibre project moved to execution in early 2026, and the state backbone programme states fibre tendering starting in the second half of 2026. The commercial project holds a fifteen-year licence and moved to execution with a local partner in early 2026 (execution , licence). The state programme runs about 2,400 km through a neighbour (tendering); the design budget and route length are the government's own figures, and the lender's implementation report puts tendering in the second half of 2026 (tendering , network , design , route). Neither has laid cable on any record held.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	International internet bandwidth	The international gateway is operated by a Swiss company which also holds the national data centre, under an oversight committee constituted with it. One privately held foreign company holds both the country's international gateway and its national data centre (gateway). No concession terms, duration, revenue share or performance condition is published for either. That concentration — international transit and national hosting in the same private hands — is stated in the record and nowhere explained.	NO CHANGE
Connectivity	Internet Exchange Points		NO EVIDENCE
Connectivity	Satellite broadband licensing and availability	No satellite broadband licence, authorisation or access terms are held; one account names a rural partnership and nothing more. One account names a rural satellite partnership and no licence, authorisation or access terms are held (account). In a country whose fibre backbone is untendered and whose coverage extensions are refused on revenue grounds, the absence of any satellite licensing record is a gap in what can be said rather than evidence that no service exists.	NO CHANGE
Data Storage	Local data centre capacity (all providers)	The national data centre was described as halfway complete in April 2026, while the regulator in January described the operator as managing critical data centre infrastructure in the present tense. The two accounts do not agree and the later one reports less progress (halfway , interest). Both are ministerial or summit statements. No construction record exists in any reachable published source: the regulator's publications page carries five documents and none concerns it, the ministry publishes nothing after December 2025, and the operator has made no statement. It is not donor-financed — the lender's project carries no data-centre workstream — so no procurement record exists where one normally would, and the operator is a privately held Swiss company of about nine people that files no public accounts. An oversight committee for gateway services and the data centre was constituted with that same company in January 2026, and no output from it is on record (committee).	MIXED a national data centre described as halfway complete in April 2026 after being described as operating in January, with no construction record in any reachable source
Data Storage	Local data centre capacity (national providers)		NO EVIDENCE
Data Storage	Off-site backup capacity		NO EVIDENCE
Energy	Sufficient energy and water for data centres		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Energy	Grid reliability	A solar-hybrid telecom energy programme took a US\$5m follow-on investment, bringing one investor's total to US\$10m. The programme is backed by a European sustainable development fund, and the site and coverage figures are the investor's and operator's own (follow-on , investment). Powering tower sites off-grid is the precondition for the coverage extensions the market has declined to fund, and this is the only energy instrument in the ledger.	ADVANCED
Energy	Rural electrification		NO EVIDENCE
Technical Capacity	Robustness of government hardware and software	A biometric registration of public servants entered its third phase for the organised forces, siloed from any identity layer and governed by no data-protection authority. The third phase launched in June 2026, backed by the lender and aimed at purging ghost workers and duplicate names (phase , drive). It is siloed from any identity layer and no data-protection authority governs it. Biometric capture of the armed and uniformed services, with no statute, no controller and no retention rule, is the most sensitive collection in this ledger.	ADVANCED
Technical Capacity	Local capacity to maintain, manage and develop government systems		NO EVIDENCE
Cybersecurity	National cybersecurity readiness	A Digital Financial Services Security Lab was stood up with the regulator, the central bank and an international body, while no national incident response team is established. The lab was stood up in March 2026 (lab). No national computer security incident response team is established, recorded as such by the lender in June 2026 (team). So the country has a sector-specific security capability for payments and no national one, a year after enacting its first computer-crime statute.	MIXED a financial-services security lab stood up while no national incident response team exists

DPI

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Exchange	National data exchange system		NO EVIDENCE
Data Exchange	Use of digital id in other systems		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Exchange	Interoperability of health systems		NO EVIDENCE
Data Exchange	Interoperability of education systems		NO EVIDENCE
Data Exchange	Interoperability of social protection systems		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Identity and CRVS	Robustness of system	A unified national digital identity system was announced for every citizen aged 18 and over, against a base in which close to 90 per cent of the population holds no government-recognised identification. The announcement came in July 2026 alongside the civil registry plan (announcement , records). Five machine systems were delivered in May 2026, two for passports and three for identity and nationality documents (machines). The production capacity is therefore arriving before the statute, the data-protection law, the register design and the fee structure that would decide who can actually use it.	ADVANCED
Digital Identity and CRVS	Registration of entire population	School-based national identity registration was launched for examination candidates, against a nationality certificate held by about 10 per cent of the population. Registration was launched at a secondary school in August 2026 with expansion to more schools planned, following card collections in one region (school , collection , issuance). The stated fee is over 50,000 South Sudanese pounds (school). About 10 per cent of the population holds a nationality certificate (certificate); stock held and cards issued are reported on different bases across sources and no single reconciled coverage figure exists (certificate). A personal identity card required for banking, land transactions and court processes stood at 380,000 held by the directorate in January 2026 (card). A fee at that level, on those coverage figures, is the access question this unit does not address.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Identity and CRVS	National maintenance of id and credentials systems	Passport stock and clearance figures were given at a directorate handover, and a new-generation passport is announced for August 2027 on a validity change with no amending instrument on file. The stock and clearance claims are the outgoing officeholder's own, made at his own handover; the annual applicant figure and a month-long delay are the incoming officeholder's (handover , testimony , booklets , resumption). The new-generation and regional passport is announced for August 2027; ten-year validity would require amending the passport act, the handover was reported as having extended adult validity already, and no amending instrument is on file while the directorate's own account puts the change before the Assembly (passport , roadmap). A validity change reported as done and simultaneously as pending is the same unreadable-instrument problem the gazette entry describes.	ADVANCED
Digital Identity and CRVS	Authentication		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Identity and CRVS	Digital id from birth		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Identity and CRVS	Interoperability of birth registration and digital id		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Identity and CRVS	Use by other systems		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Payments and Fintech	Governance role of central bank	The central bank affirmed mobile money as legal tender, and the national instant payment system has been at roadmap stage since early 2025. The affirmation was made under a 2017 electronic money regulation; the target of 30 per cent adult usage by 2027 is the central bank's own, and economists called the declaration premature in an economy over 90 per cent cash-based (affirmation , reactions). Roadmap development for the instant payment system was announced in February 2025 after a 2023 proof of concept, and nothing has moved since (roadmap). A declaration of legal tender ahead of the rail that would clear it is the sequencing this unit repeats across identity, payments and law.	MIXED mobile money affirmed as legal tender while the instant payment rail that would carry it has not moved since 2025

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	G2P functionality		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Payments and Fintech	Revenue collection	Cash payment of tax at revenue offices was barred with immediate effect in July 2026, after cash was abolished for passport and identity payments in January. The economic reform committee ordered banks to enforce cash tax payments (directive), reversing the direction the cashless measure set. The tax measure was made by resolution of a ministerial committee on economic reform, framed by the authority as a transparency and liquidity response and stated as temporary until further notice (resolution). Cash was abolished for passport and identity payments after a supply crisis in January 2026 (passports). Both are removals of the cash channel rather than additions of a digital one, in an economy widely described as overwhelmingly cash-based, and neither states an assisted or offline route for anyone without an account.	REGRESSED
Digital Payments and Fintech	B2B and B2G functionality	An interbank payment and settlement system launched with 13 banks and all licensed banks mandated by January 2026, and its real-time settlement component reported exceptional uptake. The system launched in October 2025 with all licensed banks mandated onto it by 31 January 2026. It is wholesale settlement infrastructure rather than a retail instant rail, and the retail framing used at launch was promotional (launch , explainer). The settlement component's uptake was reported as exceptional by the central bank and the finance ministry, with no volume or value figure attached (uptake). Wholesale settlement working while the retail rail has not started is the correct order, and the launch framing obscured it.	ADVANCED
Digital Payments and Fintech	P2P, P2G and P2B functionality		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	Population uptake	Mobile money operators pledged nationwide agent expansion with the central bank, and 1,225 entrepreneurs graduated from an operator training programme. The expansion pledge was made in August 2025 and no agent count, coverage figure or subsequent report is held (pledge , safeguard). The training graduation is the operator's own account, with no seed-funding total and no measure of what the training changed (training). Against an economy that remains overwhelmingly cash-based, neither a pledge nor a graduation count establishes uptake.	NO CHANGE
Digital Payments and Fintech	Cross-border functionality	Bilateral support for financial technology was reported in August 2026, with no instrument, envelope, workstream or timetable stated. The support was reported in August 2026 (support). The base holds no domestic payment system for it to attach to: the instant rail is at roadmap stage and the payment system bill is at validation workshop.	ADVANCED
Digital Payments and Fintech	Consumer protection		NO EVIDENCE
Registries	Population register		NO EVIDENCE
Registries	Civil register	A centralised civil registration system was announced with health facilities notifying births, one issuing authority and compulsory death registration, against birth registration coverage that has not moved. The announcement came in July 2026 (announcement , statelessness). Birth registration coverage has not moved on the figures held, which come from an identity diagnostic and a statelessness study rather than from a national series (coverage , study). Making death registration compulsory and centralising issuance are both enforcement designs, and neither the register nor the statute behind it exists yet.	ADVANCED
Registries	Address register		NO EVIDENCE
Registries	Business register		NO EVIDENCE
Registries	Social protection register		NO EVIDENCE
Registries	Electoral register		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Registries	Tax register		NO EVIDENCE
Registries	Land register	No digital land register programme, instrument or system is held; the record is one expert's advocacy for a central database. The advocacy was published in June 2025 in the context of land fraud (advocacy). A personal identity card is required for land transactions, so the register that would record those transactions does not exist while the credential to conduct them does.	NO CHANGE
Sectoral management information systems	Health		NO EVIDENCE
Sectoral management information systems	Education	An education in emergencies management information system was launched on the same platform the health ministry has run since 2018, after training 35 master trainers. It was launched with international partners and funded by an education fund (system). Building on an instance already running for health is the only reuse of existing government infrastructure recorded in this unit, and it is donor-led.	ADVANCED
Sectoral management information systems	Social protection		NO EVIDENCE
Sectoral management information systems	Justice		NO EVIDENCE
Sectoral management information systems	Tax	A six-year telecom revenue-assurance agreement was signed by the revenue authority and the regulator, with the vendor taking 3.56 per cent. The agreement is a build-operate-transfer arrangement (agreement). The vendor is named differently in two accounts and no source on file settles the name, which is worth stating: the party taking a percentage of telecommunications revenue for six years cannot be reliably identified from the published record.	ADVANCED
Sectoral management information systems	Customs	Electronic cargo tracking was introduced by the revenue authority for inbound goods. It was introduced in 2026 (tracking). The account reaches the base through the government's defence of the e-government concession, so the tracking system is evidenced only inside an argument about the contract that delivered it. No coverage, volume or clearance-time figure is published.	ADVANCED
Sectoral management information systems	Land		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Other GovTech and e-Gov	e-government services	An exclusive e-Government services contract was signed in 2019 without competitive tender, with the profit share put at 75 per cent by a United Nations commission and at 2 per cent by the company. The commission puts the profit share at 75 per cent to the contractor (commission); the company says it takes a 2 per cent platform service fee, which describes a separate tax contract (commission). The two accounts have not been reconciled (commission , denial , defence , partnership). The electronic visa portal runs inside that concession, applications online only with a stated 72-hour processing time and fees denominated in United States dollars, so the charge is levied through a privately operated channel (visa). The regulator separately launched its own services platform in February 2026, digitising licensing, payments and regulatory workflows (platform).	MIXED three platforms live while the exclusive concession behind them was signed without tender and its revenue share is disputed

Digitalisation

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digitalisation of sub-national government	ICT infrastructure for local government		NO EVIDENCE
Digitalisation of sub-national government	Digitalisation of local government records		NO EVIDENCE
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural health clinics		NO EVIDENCE
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural primary schools		NO EVIDENCE
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural registry offices		NO EVIDENCE
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural police stations		NO EVIDENCE

Technology

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
AI	Use of AI in government administration		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
AI	Use of AI in sectoral management information systems		NO EVIDENCE
AI	Development of national / regional AI systems		NO EVIDENCE
AI	Control of AI abuse		NO EVIDENCE
ICT Industry	National capacity in DT-related production		NO EVIDENCE
Innovation ecosystem	Technology hubs	The mobile operator opened an ICT hub in Northern Bahr el Ghazal State as a digital-skills training, scholarship and innovation facility. 2026-08-31 – the mobile operator opened the Aweil ICT Hub in Northern Bahr el Ghazal State , opened at a ceremony attended by government, education-sector, youth and development-partner representatives and described as a digital-skills training, scholarship and innovation facility. No capacity, budget, term or intake figure is published, and no public instrument stands behind it: the hub is an operator's own facility, announced by the operator, in a state where the base holds no other hub. What the record cannot say is whether it will run past the announcement.	ADVANCED
Innovation ecosystem	Tech startup ecosystem		NO EVIDENCE

Capacity

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Literacy	Digital literacy (civil service)		NO EVIDENCE
Literacy	Digital literacy (general population)		NO EVIDENCE
Training and skills	DT-related training in secondary education		NO EVIDENCE
Training and skills	DT-related university facilities and qualifications		NO EVIDENCE
Training and skills	Graduates entering DT ecosystem	A state digital skills programme is costed at US\$2,806,100 for three centres training more than 8,000 people, and its intake figures differ between the partner and the minister. The implementing partner supplied the budget; the state minister put the intake at 5,000 residents and 3,000 civil servants (programme). An educational technical cooperation project committed US\$22,336,740 for a second phase in 2020 after US\$7,084,827 for a first in 2016, both year-precise and stated in dollars by the financier (second phase , first phase). Neither carries a completion, graduate or placement figure at any date.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Research institutions	Think tanks and academic departments contributing to DT policy		NO EVIDENCE

Inclusion

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Access to services	Citizen feedback portals		NO EVIDENCE
Access to services	Citizen participation in policy	The state's own human rights commission rated the country weak on transparency and participation and very weak on accountability, with access to public information limited. Officials of the national human rights commission told a Juba panel on 2 September 2026 that the government treats civil society organisations as enemies or political opponents, rated the country weak on transparency and participation and very weak on accountability, and said access to public information remained limited with civil society given little opportunity to take part in government processes including preparation of the national budget (panel). Participants said the revenue authority, which is required to publish revenue-collection information, has not consistently done so, and that the body responsible for access to information lacks the staff and capacity to enforce the law (panel). No index, methodology or dated measurement sits behind the weak and very weak ratings, and the assessment is the state speaking about itself.	ADVANCED
Access to services	Gender equity		NO EVIDENCE
Access to services	Inclusion of persons with disabilities		NO EVIDENCE
Access to services	Inclusion of refugees and IDPs	Large-scale biometric registration and re-registration of displaced people ran from April to June 2026, with no data-controller arrangement or retention rule stated. The exercise is a humanitarian registration rather than a state system (registration , feedback). No data-controller arrangement, retention rule, consent record or relationship to the national identity system is stated. It is the largest biometric collection in this ledger and the one furthest outside any legal framework, in a country with no data-protection statute.	ADVANCED
Digital divides	Bridging of digital divides		NO EVIDENCE

Data

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
National statistics	National strategy for development of statistics		NO EVIDENCE
National statistics	Censuses and surveys	The statistics bureau published a national population estimate, with about 2.2 million of the increase attributed to migration from a neighbouring conflict. It was published at a population day dialogue in July 2026 (estimate). It is a projection rather than an enumeration, and it is the denominator under every coverage figure in this unit — identity, nationality certificates, birth registration and internet penetration all rest on it.	ADVANCED
National statistics	Statistics from administrative data		NO EVIDENCE
Open data	Use of open data		NO EVIDENCE
Use of satellite data	Agricultural use of satellite data		NO EVIDENCE
Use of satellite data	Meteorological use of satellite data		NO EVIDENCE

Geopolitics

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
US / hyperscaler activities	USA / hyperscaler MoUs, engagements and commitments	The e-Government contractor was sanctioned by the United States in May 2026, on a secondary-sourced account with no designation notice held. The sanction is reported secondarily and no designation notice is held (sanction). The company sanctioned is the one holding the exclusive e-government concession through which the visa portal and the tax platform run, so a sanctions designation and the state's principal digital service channel are the same entity.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
China activities	Chinese MoUs, engagements and commitments	A Chinese vendor re-engaged after a rift dating from 2014, and exploratory talks were held in Hangzhou in August 2026 with nothing contracted. The re-engagement was reported in February 2026, following stated interest in the country's digital future the previous September (re-engagement , interest). No contract, memorandum or workstream is named. The largest single commitment on this ledger is a Chinese loan for an air traffic management system, dated only to its year, so the relationship is substantial and almost entirely undocumented here. 2026-08-31 — the ICT minister held exploratory talks with a vendor vice-president in Hangzhou, on the sidelines of a China-Africa digital conference, and said the government is ready to seek the vendor's expertise in connecting public services . Participation is sought in smart cities, energy solutions and a national data hub in Juba, and the 2014 rift followed government accusations of hacked official email and forged documents, through which the vendor stayed in the market . Still no agreement, contract or figure.	ADVANCED
EU activities	EU MoUs, engagements and commitments		NO EVIDENCE
Gulf/UAE activities	Gulf MoUs, engagements and commitments		NO EVIDENCE
India activities	India MoUs, engagements and commitments		NO EVIDENCE

Where the record is thin

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Satellite broadband licensing and market access	A satellite-broadband licence, authorisation register or NCA decision on market access.	not yet probed
Digital land register	A land-registry digitisation programme document, procurement or ministerial decision.	not yet probed
Earth-observation or geospatial data programme	A national earth-observation or geospatial-data programme document, or an agency mandate.	not yet probed
State or county digital service delivery	A state or county digital-service platform, mandate or published local e-government plan.	not yet probed
Comprehensive data-protection statute	The Data Protection Bill as introduced, or an enacted data-protection statute and the instrument constituting its commission.	2026-08-09
Open government data portal or policy	A national open-data portal, an open-data policy, or a public-sector information reuse instrument.	not yet probed
European Union digital cooperation instrument	An EU-South Sudan digital cooperation agreement, Global Gateway commitment or delegation programme document.	not yet probed
National artificial-intelligence strategy or programme	A national AI strategy, policy or programme document, or a ministerial decision establishing one.	not yet probed
Indian digital cooperation with South Sudan	Any India-South Sudan digital cooperation agreement, line of credit or programme document.	not yet probed

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Gulf-state digital investment in South Sudan	A Gulf-state investment, financing or memorandum covering South Sudanese digital infrastructure.	not yet probed
Domestic budget appropriation for digital transformation	The national budget or its annexes showing appropriation lines for the ICT ministry, the NCA or the Electronic Services Council.	2026-08-09
Public research programme in digital or data science	A public research programme, university research-centre mandate or published research output in digital or data science.	not yet probed
Mobile coverage gap in rural counties	A coverage map, a population-coverage percentage or a universal-service obligation from the communications regulator or either operator. What the base holds instead is one community's account of messengers walking for three days to find a signal.	not yet probed

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This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.